

To Fix:

Normal attack visual and animation don't line up, make them match so its clear. Normal attack (and animation) should be in front of you, not overhead. Maybe charged attack will be overhead.

Your swing direction is locked to the direction you swing until its over, so if you turn around you'll just move backward. Is that fine?

Global Rules (Apply to All)

- **Fracture Pips:** 4 total. Gain $\frac{1}{3}$ pip per melee hit on an enemy.
 - **Limit Break (Lv4):** Costs **3 filled Fracture Pips** to activate. Lasts **6 seconds**.
 - Grants **complete immunity to knockback** and **immunity to environmental hazards** (spikes, pits, lava) for the duration.
 - **You CANNOT gain Fracture Pips** from hits during a Lv4 Limit Break or while Stillpoint is active (prevents infinite chaining).
 - **Enemy Super Armor:** Enemies are immune to knockback during their attack wind-ups.
 - **Memory Resonance:** One place in the map allows you to reallocate all your lore pips, but only once.
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Global Combat Rules

Rule 0: The Level 4 Lock

- **You can only unlock ONE Level 4 upgrade per playthrough.**
- Found in an optional endgame region. Once chosen, the other abilities are permanently capped at Level 3.
- **Design implication:** This forces meaningful build identity.

Rule 1: Charged Attack is a Persistent State (Highest Priority Overlay)

- Holding **X** starts a charge. The charge **persists** through dashes, jumps, tether pulls, and even taking damage (unless the damage is lethal).
- You can hold **X** *while* pressing (Dash), (Jump), or (Tether). The charge meter continues building in the background.
- Release **X** to swing.
- **Visual Indicator:**

- **Tap** (0–5f): Normal swing
- **Medium Hold** (6–25f): Charged Attack (Yellow Glow)
- **Full Hold** (26f+): If you have the **Lv4 Strength unlock**, this activates your Limit Break *on release* (Blue glow)

Rule 2: Stillpoint is a "Lockdown" State (Overwrites Ability Access)

- Activating Stillpoint (costs 1 or 3 Pips, depending on tap/hold).
- **While Stillpoint is active:**
 - The player moves at **100% normal speed** (at Lv1+; Lv0 may have a 50% speed penalty).
 - All enemies, projectiles, and hazards slow down (60%–90% slow, depending on level).
 - **LOCKED:** Shard Shot (**V**) hold version (lv2+ i think), Graviton Surge (**G**), Void Tether (**T**) are **completely disabled**. If you press them, nothing happens. Phase Dash (**F**) works but is just a iframe dash, no echo, no extra effects
 - **ALLOWED:** Jumping, walking, and **Charged Attacks (Hold Z)**. The Lv4 Limit Break (if you chose Strength) can still be activated via full-charge Z during Stillpoint. Tap Shard Shot (**V**) is still possible, but they are slowed too.
 - **Charged attack charge speed is capped at normal rate.**

Rule 3: Standard State Input Priority (Outside Stillpoint)

When Stillpoint is **not** active, the game reads your inputs in this strict order per frame:

Priority	Input	Behavior
1 (Highest)	F (Phase Dash)	Cancels everything (including charge swings). Instantly dashes. Your charge is dropped (you can start re-charging immediately after). Same with normal dash
2	G (Graviton Surge)	If pressed, it queues the gravity flip. If you are mid-swing, the flip happens on the <i>next idle frame</i> (doesn't interrupt your attack). If you are mid-dash, it waits until the dash ends.
3	T (Void Tether)	Fires the tether. If you are holding Z (charging) at the same time, the charge <i>continues</i> in the background while the tether fires (you don't drop the charge).
4	Z (Attack)	If you tap it, swing. If you hold it, start charging. Charging persists through all actions except Phase Dash (which cancels it).

1. Strength (Normal & Charged Attacks)

Base ability: Standard slash (Z) and hold-to-charge heavy attack.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Melee slash (18f cooldown, 1 dmg). Charged attack (40f charge, 2 dmg, moderate knockback).
Lv 1	Attack speed +15% (18f → 15f).
Lv 2	Damage +20% (1 → 1.2). Charged attack knockback +30% .
Lv 3	Incoming knockback on player -30% . Damage +25% (total now +45%; 1 → 1.45 dmg).
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : Attack speed +25%, Damage +50% (total 1.95 dmg), zero knockback, hazard immunity. Melee becomes a 3-hit combo (slash → slash → heavy slam). Charged attacks launch enemies into walls for +1 bonus wall-bounce damage .

2. Phase Dash

*Base ability: Found in Mirror Veil (C). Leaves a stunning echo at the **start** location.*

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Phase Dash (F). Dashes horizontally . Leaves an echo at the start location that stuns enemies for 30 frames .
Lv 1	Dash becomes 8-directional (aim with WASD/arrows). <i>Applies to the regular dash (C) too.</i>
Lv 2	Echo stun duration +30% (30f → 40f).
Lv 3	When you swing your sword, the echo attacks once from its position (deals 50% of your normal damage), then fades.
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : The echo becomes a Stand (follows you). It mirrors your every melee attack (deals 100% damage), zero knockback, hazard immunity. Effectively doubles your melee DPS for 6 seconds.

3. Shard Shot

Base ability: Fire a single shard projectile (V).

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Fires 1 shard. Deals 1 damage.
Lv 1	Damage +25% (1 → 1.25).
Lv 2	Fires 2 shards simultaneously (slight horizontal spread).
Lv 3	Beam Attack: Hold V to charge. Fires a piercing laser (deals 2 damage, passes through enemies). Costs 1 Fracture Pip if held longer than 1 second.
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State: Your melee swings are replaced with close-range Shard Blasts (glowing projectiles, 150% melee damage). Hold V for the Beam—it now deals 3 damage and pierces infinitely. Zero knockback, hazard immunity.

4. Stillpoint

Base ability: Tap (1 pip) for a short dodge-window; Hold (3 pips) for a long slow. Lifesteal cap starts at 1 HP per use.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Tap (1 Pip): 25 frames (0.4s) of 60% slow. Hold (3 Pips): 90 frames (1.5s) of 60% slow. Lifesteal cap = 1 HP .
Lv 1	Duration +25% (Tap → 31f, Hold → 112f). Lifesteal cap stays 1.
Lv 2	Lifesteal cap increases to 2 HP .
Lv 3	Slow increases to 90% (almost complete stop). Lifesteal cap increases to 3 HP .
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State: On activation, time stops fully for 2 seconds (enemies/projectiles freeze). For the remaining 4 seconds, time is slowed to 90%. Lifesteal cap increases to 4 HP . Zero knockback, hazard immunity.

5. Graviton Surge

Base ability: Flip gravity (G) for 3 seconds. Costs 1 Pip.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Reverses gravity for 3s. Enemies slamming into the ceiling/floor take 0 damage (just a stun).
Lv 1	Duration +1s (4s total). Enemies take 1 damage when they slam into the ceiling or floor.
Lv 2	Hold G to create a "Gravity Ball" that pulls nearby enemies toward it. <i>Tap duration increases to 5s.</i>
Lv 3	Gravity Ball explodes on release (deals 4 damage , 300% knockback). <i>Tap duration increases to 6s.</i>
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : Gain Flight (fly freely, ignoring gravity). The Gravity Ball pulls enemies 50% faster and deals 6 damage on explosion. Zero knockback, hazard immunity. During Enhanced State, knockback is increased (200%). +1 bonus wall-bounce damage .

6. Void Tether

Base ability: Grappling hook (T). Costs 1 Pip. Pulls enemies to you, or pulls you to walls.

Level	Effect
Lv 0	Standard tether. Pulls 1 target. No added effect.
Lv 1	Tether range +30% .
Lv 2	Tether becomes Electrified . When the enemy reaches you, they take +1 bonus damage and are stunned for 15 frames.
Lv 3	Pull speed +50% . The electrical stun arcs/chains to 1 nearby enemy (small AoE stun).
Lv 4 (Limit Break)	Costs 3 Pips. 6s Enhanced State : Tether costs 0 Pips to cast. Inflicts Fire (spreads to nearby enemies) dealing 2 damage per second for 3 seconds on the reeled-in target. Zero knockback, hazard immunity.